traditional methods. By using stablecoins in the Lightning Network, international transactions can be processed quickly, reducing the time required to complete the transaction.

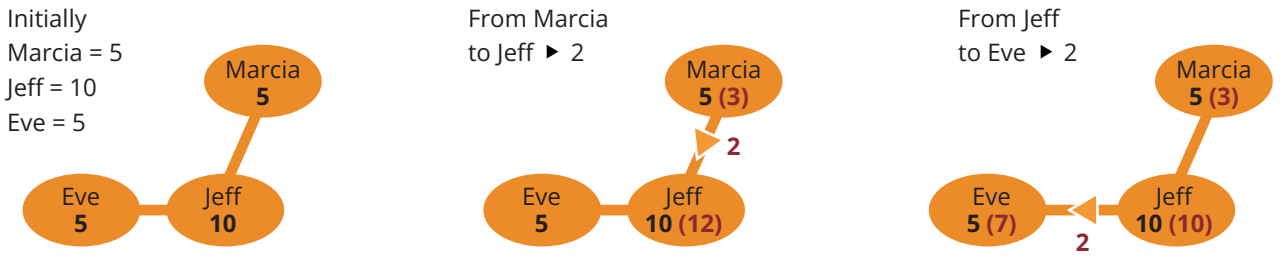
3. Improved access: For individuals or businesses in countries with limited access to traditional banking services, the use of stablecoins in the Lightning Network can provide a means to make international payments, thereby improving access to financial services.

6.3.1 A Lightning Transaction

Example#1

• Below, Marcia has 5 units of some currency and Eve has 5 units as well. Marcia wants to send 2 of her units to Eve, so she sends 2 units to Jeff. Jeff then passes on the 2 units to Eve, who now has 7 units. Marcia now has 3 units. And that's it! The transaction is done.

The key point here is that Marcia and Eve don't have to go through a bank or other intermediary to make the transaction happen.



• Jeff acts as an intermediary or a "**trusted third party**" in this scenario, where Marcia and Eve do not trust each other directly. Jeff receives the 2 units from Marcia and then passes it on to Eve, thus completing the transaction. By using Jeff as an intermediary, Marcia and Eve can complete the transaction without the need for a bank or other centralized institution, which can make the transaction faster, cheaper, and more secure. Jeff is a key element in this peer-to-peer transaction process

As a node operator in a Lightning Network transaction, Jeff benefits in several ways:

1. Transaction fees: Jeff earns a small fee for each transaction that passes through his node, which compensates him for the time and effort he puts into maintaining and running his node.

2. Network participation: By running a Lightning node, Jeff is participating in the network and helping to increase its decentralization, security, and stability. This can increase Jeff's reputation and credibility as a reliable node operator, making him a more attractive intermediary for future transactions.